

Buffers in Node.js

- Buffer = fixed-size chunk of raw binary memory
- lives OUTSIDE the V8 heap
- Buffer.alloc(10) -> 10 bytes, zero-filled (safe)
- Buffer.allocUnsafe(10) -> faster, old data inside!
- Buffer.from('hello', 'utf8')
- buf.toString('base64') / 'hex'
- 1 char != 1 byte (utf8 emoji = 4 bytes)
- Buffer.byteLength('héllö') = 6
- new Buffer() is DEPRECATED -> never use
- streams give data as Buffers by default

Remember: allocUnsafe only if you overwrite every byte right away!!